3. In this respect two present-day examples are interesting to ponder: the impossibility to predict and contain capitalist crises, like the recent one that exploded in 2008 in the United States and continues with devastating effects in Europe, and the practice of the National Security Agency (NSA) of the US to spy on global correspondence and activities, unveiled by Edward Snowden.
4. This generalisation does not mean egalitarian homogenisation; it is the most powerful historic way of creating inequality. This 'generalisation' signifies an international space entirely given over to reproducing value, marked by states that are unequal among themselves and stuck in ever-increasing social inequalities. As pointed out by Meszaros (2002), this assumption represents a threat to the very existence of humanity.
5. The category *financialisation* is often presented in an imprecise manner. Sometimes it is close to Lenin's formulation, which signals an intimate relation between industrial and bank capital; at other times it rejects this formulation by limiting itself to banking activity including stock exchange values and the financial, not banking, sector. We start from Lenin's premise although warning of a quantum leap in the fusion between the diverse capital sectors, as we shall see below.
6. This period, 1945–75, is often idealised as manifesting a 'normalisation' of capitalism under the generous management of the welfare state. In fact, this was the tonic for the people of Western Europe, the United States, Japan and also a small handful of nations. For a good part of the rest of the countries, this was a time of bloody anti-colonial struggles and subsequent foreign military interventions (such as in Latin America) and bloody dictatorships with US support and European complicity.
7. In that period no European country experienced the persecution of communists that McCarthyism imposed on the United States in spite of its 'model' character as well as the reach of its ideology being shaped by the cinema, above all.
8. Dreifuss (1986) studied the early beginnings of business think tanks originating in the UK and the US, disseminated to cover just about all of the continents, absorbing intellectuals and businessmen of innumerable countries. See also Gramsci's broad and far-reaching reflection on the form of capitalist state organisation from the 1920s and 1930s, when the state expanded through tight interlocking with private hegemonic apparatuses (civil society).
9. Marini early on emphasised the relative autonomy of the state in order that subaltern countries such as Brazil under the military dictatorship introduce a sub-imperialist policy (Marini 1977:20–21).
10. With varied levels of complexity, different authors argue that technology can eliminate (or reduce to tiny levels) the number of workers necessary for capital reproduction. The coherence of this reasoning ignores the fact that the general reproduction of capital has never limited itself to the relation between any particular national capital and 'its' workers. If this were true in capitalism's early beginnings, such as in the case of slavery, particularly of Africans, it becomes even truer after modern imperialist expansion at the end of the 20th century.
11. Various technologies and chemical inputs were introduced in different countries since the 1960s, aiming at a rapid industrialisation of agricultural production. Production growth was accompanied by the concentration of landed property, social inequality, water and soil pollution, and propagation of hybrid or transgenic products with risks to human health.
12. The commercialisation of seeds is not a new phenomenon and did not until recently imply large-scale expropriation. The international imposition of transgenic seeds, especially the Terminator type (which does not create new seeds except those of very short life), can colonise fields sown with native seeds (even against farmers' wishes). Disseminating these seeds on a large scale opens the terrible possibility that the historical ability of human beings to freely cultivate their food will be destroyed. It seems that a series of biological expropriations are in progress whose consequences are yet unknown.
13. Just as they are incapable of preventing economic crises, they also are unable to prevent processes of a socialist nature from implanting themselves in diverse countries. The most evident cases are those of Cuba, Venezuela and Bolivia, which resist permanent harassment. In later popular manifestations such as in the Middle East, international interference has been